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Democracy Dies in Darkness

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Trump, Putin will meet next week in Alaska

BY JONATHAN EDWARDS,
SIOBHÁN O'GRADY,
JOHN HUDSON
AND CATHERINE BELTON

President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin will meet next week in the United States as Trump pushes for a peace agreement that could require Ukraine to make major territorial concessions.

The two leaders will meet Aug. 15 in Alaska, Trump and a

LEADERS TO TALK TERMS ON UKRAINE TRUCE

Kyiv may need to cede territory, U.S. president says

Putin aide said, to try to forge a truce and end the war in Ukraine that Russia started 3½ years ago by invading the country. Trump did not say whether Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky would be attending.

Earlier in the afternoon,

Trump told reporters the terms of a peace agreement may require Ukraine to cede territory to Russia, a concession that would be difficult to accept for the country and its European supporters.

“You’re looking at territory

that’s been fought over for 3½ years with — you know, a lot of Russians have died, a lot of Ukrainians have died,” Trump said. “There’ll be some swapping of territories to the betterment of both.”

Movement toward a summit between Trump and Putin has accelerated rapidly since Wednesday, when Trump’s envoy Steve Witkoff met with Putin for three hours in Moscow. Witkoff left the meeting with a proposal

from Putin, which Secretary of State Marco Rubio said “for the first time” provided “concrete examples of the kinds of things that Russia would ask for in order to end the war.”

What Trump meant by swapping territory is unclear. Ukraine controls only around four square miles of Russian land in the western Kursk region. Russia, meanwhile, controls around a fifth of Ukraine’s

SEE PUTIN ON A5

Plans on table to use military in cartel fight

Naval and drone strikes are weighed, officials say, but no boots on ground

BY DAN LAMOTHE,
TARA COPP,
MARY BETH SHERIDAN
AND WARREN P. STROBEL

The Trump administration is evaluating plans for using military force against Mexican drug cartels, current and former U.S. officials said, a potentially dramatic escalation for the United States in Latin America.

Discussions have ranged from using Navy destroyers to launch missiles at cartel leaders or infrastructure to partnering more closely with Mexican authorities to target the criminal organizations, a U.S. official familiar with the issue said. Military strikes would be “audacious” and potentially unlikely to get approval from the president, said the official, who like others spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the issue.

A second U.S. official said that there is no consideration for putting U.S. troops on the ground in

SEE CARTELS ON A6

New tariffs likely to make cars, clothes, coffee pricier

BY ABHA BHATTARAI
AND JACLYN PEISER

Americans are paying more for appliances, home furnishings, toys and shoes than they were a few months ago, and they could soon face higher prices on more goods as the Trump administration’s latest round of sharper tariffs kicks in.

The newest round of duties took effect Thursday, lifting the average U.S. tariff rate to its highest level since the Great Depression. The move solidifies the president’s trade policy after months of negotiations, meaning more manufacturers and retailers are expected to begin raising prices in short order.

“Tariffs have moved from being tentative to permanent — and that changes how American

SEE TARIFFS ON A9

Deal with Japan: Tokyo questions details of vague U.S. agreement. **A9**



CAROLYN VAN HOUTEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

BY MICHAEL E. MILLER
IN MUANI, FIJI

For years, this coastal village has tried to overcome the effects of climate change. When rising seas began to lap at their doors, residents built a seawall. When flooding continued, they dug culverts and trucked in rock and sand.

But the ocean now spills over the seawall, fills the culverts, and erodes the rock and sand. And so, villagers have decided it’s time to move. To move Muani, wooden house by wooden house, a few hundred yards to the top of a densely forested hill.

“It will be tough,” rasped Alivereti Taito, the 92-year-old chief, between cigarettes and cups of kava, a brown, peppery drink that has a mild numbing effect. “But I am worried about the village.”

Now the question is whether Muani can

Faced with rising seas and falling aid, Fijian villages move uphill

Mariana Sarawaqa stands among mangroves she planted to help protect the shoreline as sea levels rise in Vunisavisavi, Fiji.

afford to wait for the government’s help, or whether it will have to move on its own.

Over the past decade, Fiji has become a laboratory for an issue that will soon affect millions of people around the globe: climate-driven relocation. It was among the first countries to move a community threatened by climate change when, in 2014, it shifted the sinking village of Vunidogoloa a mile uphill on Fiji’s second-largest island, Vanua Levu.

Fiji has since become an authority on the logistically and culturally fraught process, with more than 40 villages — including Muani — earmarked for potential relocation.

What this nation of 950,000 doesn’t have, however, is the money to relocate them all.

Developing countries have long demanded assistance from the wealthier nations responsible for the vast majority of the carbon emissions driving climate change. That help began

SEE FIJI ON A10

For MLB’s first female umpire, it’s the call of a lifetime

BY CHELSEA JANES

For the first time in nearly 150 years of Major League Baseball, a female umpire will work a regular season game. Jen Pawol, a 48-year-old former college softball player from New Jersey, will call outs on the bases for two games of a doubleheader Saturday between the Miami Marlins and Atlanta Braves. On Sunday, she will stand behind home plate and call balls and strikes.

She isn’t shying from the moment.

“I really am aware of it. I’m aware of the gravity. I’m aware of the magnitude,” Pawol said. “I believe I’m going to be a really good steward and representative for young girls and women — and

boys and men — that this is possible.”

While celebration is only natural, it is worth pointing out that MLB only narrowly avoided having robots call balls and strikes before a woman. The NBA introduced its first female referees almost three decades ago. The NFL has trusted women to officiate for 10 years. The men’s FIFA World Cup used its first all-female crew in Qatar in 2022. Pawol, an umpire in the minor leagues for nearly a decade, is the closest MLB has come. But most glass ceilings are overdue for shattering. Better shards fly late than never.

“This historic accomplishment in baseball is a reflection of Jen’s

SEE PAWOL ON A6



SAUL MARTINEZ/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Jen Pawol, shown in February 2024, will become the first female umpire to work a regular season MLB game Saturday in Atlanta.

JAMES A. LOVELL JR. 1928-2025

Resourceful astronaut piloted treacherous Apollo 13 mission

BY RACHEL FELTMAN

James A. Lovell Jr., the American astronaut who commanded the Apollo 13 spacecraft on its lunar voyage in 1970 and shepherded it on a perilous four-day journey back to Earth after an oxygen tank exploded, an ordeal that transfixed the world, died Aug. 7 in Lake Forest, Illinois. He was 97.

NASA announced his death in a statement, which did not cite a cause.

Apollo 13, which became the subject of a film starring Tom Hanks as Mr. Lovell, was one of the



Capt. James A. Lovell Jr. also piloted the Gemini 7 space mission in 1965.

U.S. space missions most firmly etched in the public consciousness after John Glenn’s orbit of the Earth in 1962 and the moon landing of Apollo 11 in 1969.

Those earlier flights were resounding triumphs for the space program, securing American pre-

SEE LOVELL ON A18

IN THE NEWS

Recovery funds delayed DHS is holding up over \$100 million that was approved to help North Carolina after Hurricane Helene. **A3**

Israel escalates Its newly approved plan to occupy Gaza City marks a significant shift in the war and paves the way for a phased takeover of the entire enclave. **A8**

THE NATION
Rep. Cory Mills denied vowing to release explicit material tied to a former girlfriend. **A4**
In Texas’s fight over redistricting, an official sued to oust 13 Democrats from office. **A5**

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Trump upstaged Russia, presiding over an Armenia-Azerbaijan peace framework. **A7**
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Walmart knew water bottles it sold carried an explosion risk years before recalling them, the company confirmed. **A13**

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A history museum’s impeachment display again includes Trump, but in less detail. **B1**
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As the Nationals’ rebuild goes off the rails, we spent a night talking to fans who truly love this team. They’re going through some things. **B7**

THE REGION
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A man who formerly worked at the Australian Embassy was arrested and charged with sexually abusing three children in D.C. **B13**

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